

DESERT WHISPERS

January 1981

HAPPY NEW YEARS

New Year's Day is a time of universal celebration but not everyone celebrates the same day. Such celebrations are at least as old as the Babylonian festival of Marduk in 3000 B.C. The new year began in Babylonia with the vernal equinox. In Egypt, Phoenicia & Persia it began with the autumnal equinox. In Rome the winter solstice was the beginning of the year until Julius Caesar advanced the date to January 1. It was not until 1752 that January 1 was universally accepted by the English speaking nations as New Year's Day. The Jewish New Year occurs near the first of September. The Chinese New Year begins between January 21 and February 19. The Greek New Year begins on January 13.

In the United States New Year's is a national holiday. A time for exchanging greetings and making resolutions. Many churches hold watch parties to see the old year out and the new one in, while others enjoy midnight suppers and dances. In many towns and hamlets bells are rung, whistles are blown, guns are fired to make noise at the moment the old year dies.

In many countries it is traditional to give New Year gifts. In the colonial years of America, New Years calling was practiced. On New Year's Day part of the family stayed home to serve punch, cookies etc. to all the friends and neighbors who came calling. The other members of the family went out to call on the friends and neighbors at their homes who were likewise serving refreshments. It was more fun than New Years cards and certainly more fattening.

However you plan to observe the demise of the old and the birth of the new, the staff of Desert Whispers wishes you a HAPPY & PROSPEROUS 1981.

BUSINESS OF THE MONTH

The Gift Shop, a new business in Christmas Valley, is owned by Gilbert and Marilyn Ort. The Orts are former Silverton, Oregon, residents. Mr. Ort was foreman at Molalla Lumber Mill for many years. The Orts have four children. Their daughter is a senior in high school at Silverton. Two sons are married and live in Silverton and a third son is a second year college student in Salem.

The Gift Shop is located on Christmas Valley Road west of the cattle-guard. The Shop, which features woodcrafts, stuffed animals, macrame items and many handcrafted gifts, is open from 9 to 5, Tuesday through Sunday. Mrs. Ort said there are new items coming in all the time.

If you have ever wanted to send someone a card from Christmas Valley
(continued on Pg. 2)

BUSINESS OF THE MONTH - Cont'd

The Gift Shop is the place to buy one. The Orts have a variety of cards with the name Christmas Valley imprinted on the cards. Area residents with a talent for handicrafts will find the Gift Shop a good place to consign their articles.

Mr. Ort is operating his brush beating service while Mrs. Ort takes care of The Gift Shop. To contact the Orts, you may call 576-2307 or drop by anyday except Monday.

North Lake County's problems concerning our law enforcement seems to have taken the front row, in all of our attention lately.

It seems that since, our new Sheriff elect has been starting his proposed entry into the position he has been elected to, we of the North End must pay a dear price.

WE MAY LOOSE OUR FRIEND AND OFFICER, RON JOHNSON.

I can remember when we were without this friend and protector of human rights and property here in the Northern end of our County: I can also remember when he first came to our area and donated his time and effort to help us. I am, for one, happy with our Deputy and do not want to see another in his place. He is fair and aware of all our problems. We have always been able to call for help and he would be there.

We need a seasoned officer in crime prevention, friend & confident in this area. We need to keep Ron Johnson. We like the way he has taken care of our problems. Why do we have to pay that price because of internal problems within the Sheriffs Dept.

Esther B. Chambers.
ESTHER B. CHAMBERS
Christmas Valley

The above is a paid ad.

Valley Foods

HAPPY NEW YEAR

Open 9 AM - 9 PM, Monday - Saturday
10 AM - 7 PM, Sunday
9 AM - 12 Noon, Holidays

GROCERIES - ICE - COLD BEER & POP

HAPPY NEW YEAR from the

Gift Shop

We will be closed from Noon
December 23 through December 29.

We are adding new and different items as we go along.

the Queen Bee

Last minute shopping - Open 7 days a week, 11 AM - 6 PM til Xmas.

Closed December 25 through
December 31.

DON'T FORGET THE DRAWING Dec. 24th
at 6 P.M.

Notice has been received by the Christmas Valley Park & Recreation Dept. that use of motorized vehicles on specified public lands in the Black Hills is permanently closed. This closure does not apply to emergency, law enforcement, federal or other Government vehicles while being used for official or emergency purposes, or vehicles authorized by permit or contract.

The areas affected by this designation and restriction notice are located approximately four miles south of Christmas Valley. See Map on Page 3A.

Recently 15,520 acres of the Fossil Lake/Sand Dunes/Lost Forest area have been identified as a Wilderness Study Area. The Wilderness Study Area includes that portion of the Fossil Lake Closure east of the BPA Powerline. It also includes a small portion of the Lost Forest Research Natural area. See Map on page 3B

To those of you who use the sand dunes for ORV recreation, the Wilderness Study designation does NOT prohibit you from continuing to use it for ORV enjoyment. However, this study designation does not remove the vehicle restrictions from Fossil Lake and Lost Forest. If you plan to use the Sand Dunes for ORV recreation in the future, please obey the vehicle closures at Fossil Lake and Lost Forest.

If the Sand dunes area between Fossil Lake and Lost Forest should be designated by Congress for wilderness in the future, it would be closed to all vehicles.

EMT 1 Course a Possibility -

There is a possibility of an EMT 1 course being offered in the North End of Lake County, taking in Silver Lake, Christmas Valley and Fort Rock. Twelve people must take the course to have it offered in this area.

Our area is short of EMT's and more help is needed. If interested call Bobbie Michelson at 576-2224 or Linda Anderson at 576-2178 or contact Sue Johnson in Christmas Valley.

CHRISTMAS VALLEY LIONESS

The Christmas Valley Lioness meet the 2nd Tuesday of every month, 2:30 PM at the Christmas Valley Lodge.

CELEBRATE NEW YEARS EVE
at
CHRISTMAS VALLEY LODGE

Restaurant closed at 8 PM
Dance starts at 9 PM

Cover charge \$10.00 per
person, includes dance,
party favors, and
breakfast at 1 AM

"LIVE MUSIC"

COME ON DOWN
NO MINORS PLEASE

This paper is published monthly by
Christmas Valley Park & Recreation
Dept.

Advertising Rates:

\$ 5.00 for less than 1/4th page
10.00 for 1/4th page
20.00 for 1/2 page
40.00 for full page
2.00 for personal greetings of
10 words

Mail ads to:

Desert Whispers
P.O. Box 181
Christmas Valley, Oregon 97638

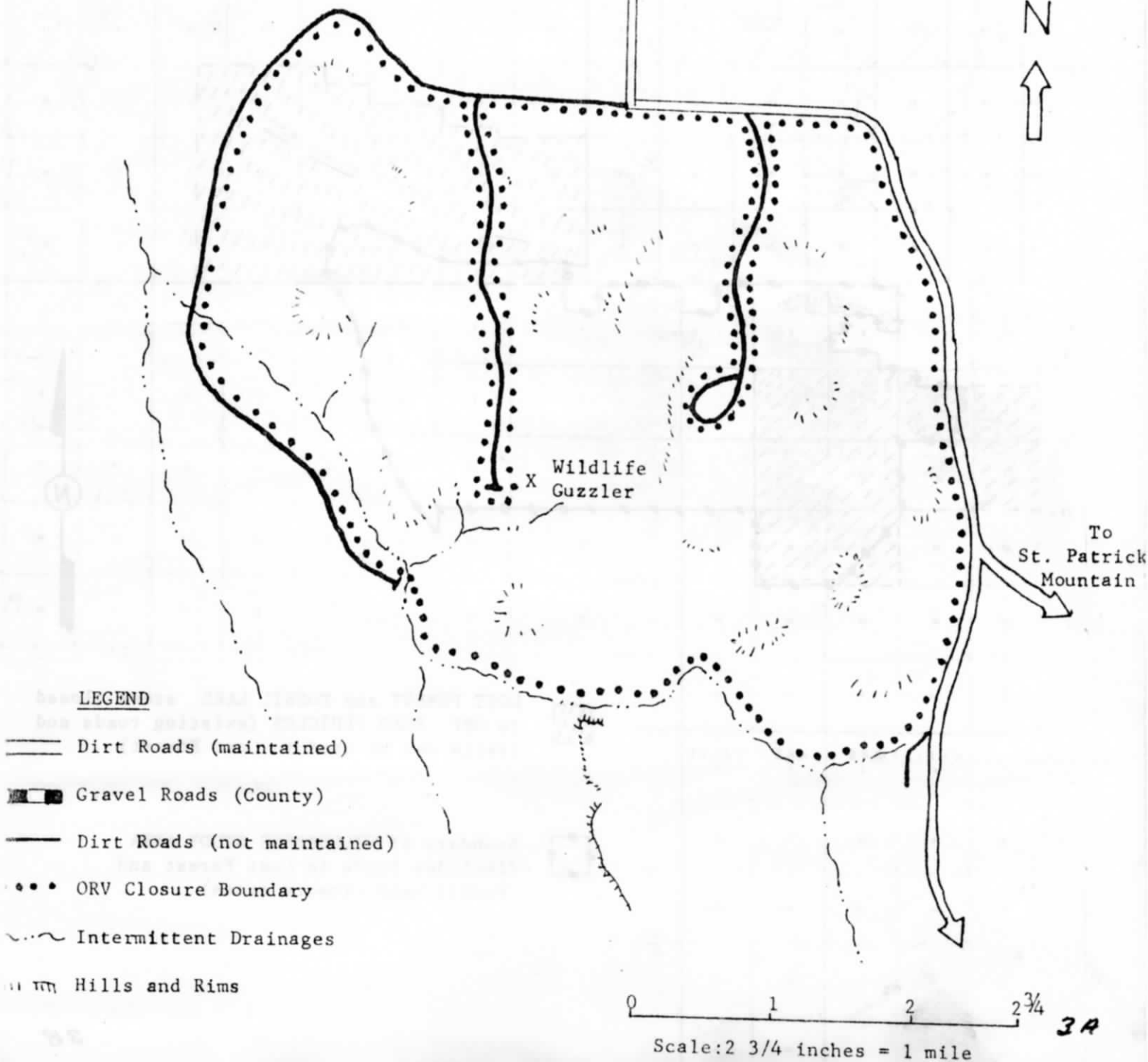


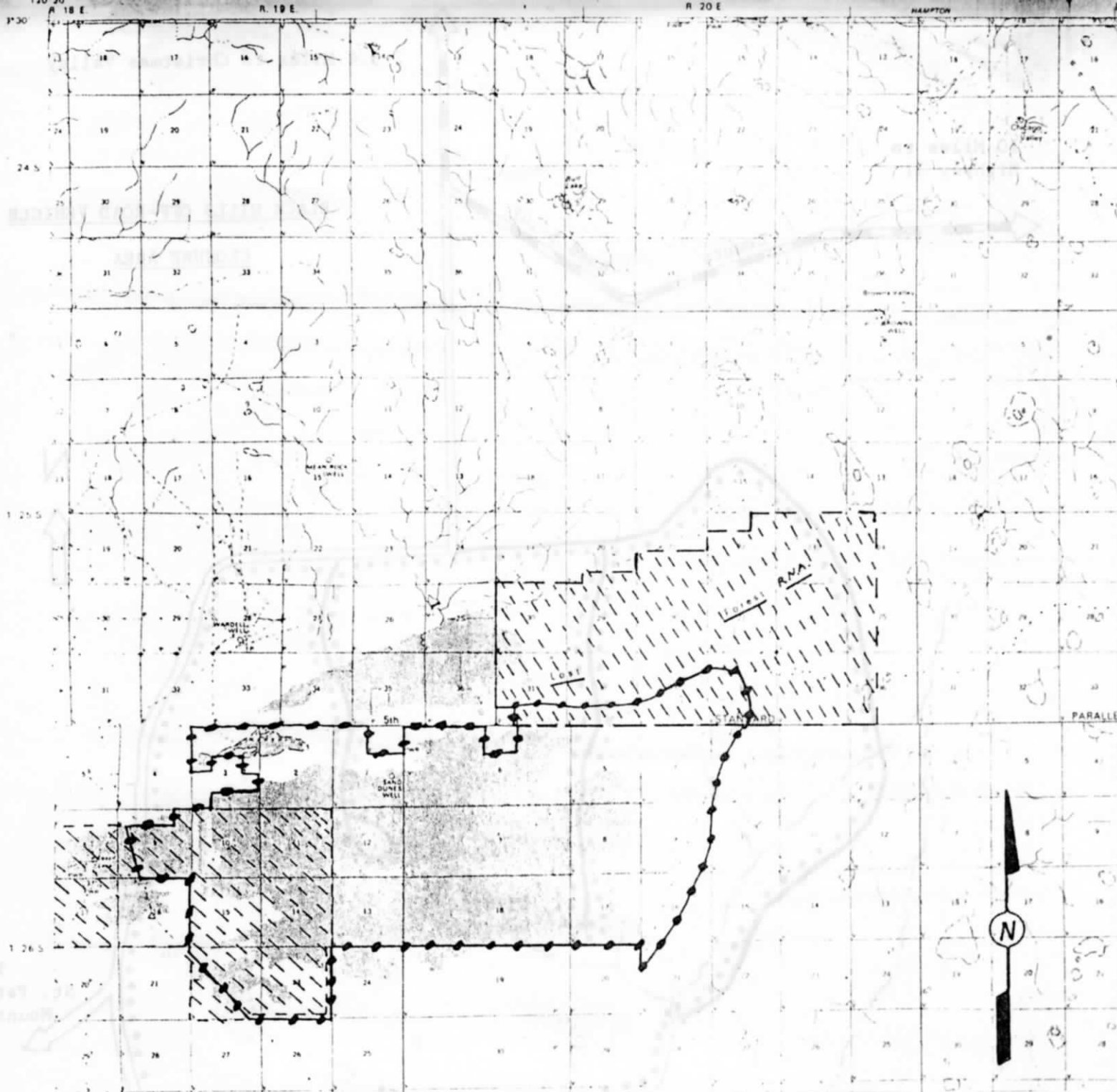
2 3/4 Miles to Christmas Valley

10 Miles to
Highway 31

BLACK HILLS OFF-ROAD VEHICLE

CLOSURE AREA





CHRISTMAS LAKE VALLEY



LOST FOREST and FOSSIL LAKE areas closed to OFF- ROAD VEHICLES (existing roads and trails may be used in Lost Forest)



Boundary of WILDERNESS STUDY AREA (includes lands in Lost Forest and Fossil Lake closure areas)

CHRISTMAS VALLEY BOARDS

CHRISTMAS VALLEY RURAL FIRE PROTECTION DISTRICT:

Insurance Services Office of Oregon made a survey of the Christmas Valley Rural Fire Protection District for the purpose of gathering information needed to determine a fire insurance classification which may be used to develop fire insurance rates. Christmas Valley has a rating of 8 within the Water District; outside of the Water District the rating is 9.

CHRISTMAS VALLEY PARK & RECREATION DEPT.:

Sue Johnson reported two faucets were broken at the rodeo grounds. Two shut-offs for the water faucets are to be purchased and installed.

Red Johnson is now taking care of the rodeo grounds.

Next meeting to be January 8, 1981 at 6:30 P.M.

CHRISTMAS VALLEY AMBULANCE:

The ambulance has had one run so far this month, plus one call to aid a heart victim.

The Lioness have volunteered to help Sue Johnson with the EMT Third annual Sweetheart Ball, a fund raising event for the ambulance to be held in February.

HAPPY HOLIDAY'S from everyone at

Pettus Realty

Evelyn Pettus

John Pettus

Wanda Dutcher

Linda Parmenter

Yvonne Woods

Phone 576-2284

*Desert Inn
Motel*

HAPPY HOLIDAY'S TO EVERYONE

12 units - 4 single & 8 double

Single units have 1 double bed
and small refrigerators.

Double rooms have kitchenettes
and 2 double beds. Color TV

Weekly & Monthly rates.

Bud & Peggy Maple, Owners
Desert Inn Motel
P.O. Box 240
Christmas Valley, Oregon
97638

Phone 576-2262

SANTA CLAUS COMES TO TOWN:

Santa & Mrs. Claus arrived at the Christmas Valley Community Hall via the Christmas Valley Fire Dept. truck at approximately 12:15 PM on Saturday, December 13th, with gifts and candy canes for all the children of the valley.

LION'S CLUB

The Christmas Valley Lion's Club recently paid for an eye examination and a pair of glasses for a ten year old Christmas Valley student. Eye conservation and assistance is one of the Lion's Club's main projects. In the past the local club has helped a 73 year old man and a pre-school child.

The Silver Lake Lion's Club is sponsoring the new Fort Rock Lion's Club. On December 12, the Silver Lake and Christmas Valley Clubs went to Fort Rock for the official formation of the Fort Rock Club.

District Governor Dr. Todd Rowe and State Executive Secretary Harvey Calame attended the Fort Rock Meeting. Walter Foote was selected as president of the approximately 20 members of the new club.

Tom Scurlock, pledge chairman, reported that approximately \$1400.00 has been pledged so far by the Christmas Valley members toward building a new wing at Good Samaritan Hospital in Portland. The money pledged is for a three year period. The Christmas Valley Club has 27 members.

WATER RESOURCES DEPT.

Approximately 80 persons attended an informational Oregon Water Resources Dept. meeting at the Christmas Valley Community Hall on December 10th. Jim Sexton and Al Petska represented the Water Resources Dept.

Mr. Sexton indicated that the previous recommendation against releasing possible Desert Land Entry Bureau of Land Management properties was being rescinded. He stated that such land would be treated the same as other private property should the BLM release the land.

Mr. Petska and Mr. Sexton outlined monitoring plans for the Silver Lake, Fort Rock, Christmas Valley Basin. They indicated that the approximate cost for installing water meters on EACH irrigation well in the basin would be \$1000.00. The meters, which are to be paid for by the well owners will be monitored for 5 years. The reason for the monitoring system was presented by Mr. Petska. He indicated that there has been a gradual decline in the water level over the past five years. He said since 1975, the level has declined 4 to 5 feet.

Thanks to all our friends and patrons who have helped make this last year a successful one. We would like to take this opportunity to wish all of you

HAPPY HOLIDAYS & A PROSPEROUS
1981

Trail

Gavern & Restaurant

Mr. Sexton & Mr. Petska said the water permits call for a meter system.

Richard "Art" Gerity and his staff from the Lakeview Office of the BLM fielded questions from the audience about the possible DLE properties.